



InterQual® Acute Criteria

Conducting a Review

InterQual Acute Adult Criteria are for review of patients ≥ 18 years of age.

InterQual Acute Pediatric Criteria are for review of patients < 18 years of age.



To conduct a review, follow these steps:

1. Select the most appropriate subset based on the primary condition or working diagnosis.
2. Select either Initial review or the appropriate episode day.
Note: Initial review is used only before the decision to admit has been made.
3. Select a level of care based on the patient’s current or proposed level of care.
4. Select criteria based on the patient’s clinical finding, treatment, and service while meeting all criteria rules and time parameters. Read all notes and any organizational policies.
5. Take the appropriate action based on the review findings:

Review Finding	Action
Initial review criteria are met	1. Approve recommended level of care. 2. Conduct Episode Day 1 review when full medication or intervention orders are available.
Episode Day criteria or Partial responder criteria are met	1. Approve level of care for that episode day. 2. Schedule next review.
Responder criteria are met	Prepare for discharge. Review Discharge Screens to determine appropriate post-acute level of care.
Non-responder criteria are met	Select Extended Stay subset, if applicable, and conduct a review or refer for secondary review.

Review Finding	Action
Episode Day criteria, Responder, Partial responder, and Non-responder are not met	Obtain additional information from attending medical practitioner or other caregivers: • If additional information does not support criteria, discuss condition with medical practitioner. An alternate setting may be more appropriate for managing the patient's condition. • Facilitate transfer if medical practitioner is agreeable to alternate setting or level of care. • Refer for secondary review if medical practitioner does not agree.